

PPC Metrics Cheat Sheet

The formulas behind ACOS, TACOS, ROAS, CTR, CVR, and CPC — and what a shift in each one usually means.

Keep this open while you work. Every formula here uses numbers straight off Amazon's own reports.

Efficiency Metrics

Metric	Formula	Read it as
ACOS	$\text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Ad Sales}$	Cents of ad spend per dollar of ad sales. Lower = more efficient.
TACOS	$\text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Total Sales}$	Ad spend as a share of the WHOLE business, ads + organic.
ROAS	$\text{Ad Sales} \div \text{Ad Spend}$	Revenue multiple per ad dollar. The inverse of ACOS.
CPA	$\text{Ad Spend} \div \text{Orders}$	Dollar cost of a single order from ads.

Traffic & Conversion Metrics

Metric	Formula	Read it as
CTR	$\text{Clicks} \div \text{Impressions}$	Ad appeal — image, title, price, star rating, review count.
CVR	$\text{Orders} \div \text{Clicks}$	Listing quality — once they click, do they buy?
CPC	$\text{Spend} \div \text{Clicks}$	What you actually paid per click, on average.

Quick Diagnosis

Symptom	Likely cause	Where to look
High spend, low CTR	Ad isn't compelling relative to competitors	Main image, price positioning, star rating
Good CTR, low CVR	Listing doesn't close the sale	Bullets, A+ Content, reviews, price
Good CVR, high ACOS	Winning the click too expensively	Bid, placement modifiers, match type precision
Rising TACOS, flat ACOS	Ads are cannibalizing organic sales, not adding incremental revenue	Organic search and keyword overlap

"Healthy" ACOS varies enormously by category, margin, and whether the goal is profit or growth/rank — there is no universal target number. Always use the client's own break-even ACOS (Gross Margin %), not a generic benchmark.